COMPETITOR TEARDOWN · AI SEARCH AGENCY

Discovered Labs

How the best packaged AEO agency for B2B SaaS wins, where it is exposed, and what Rank Collective and Appear should take from it.

> They win on three things we can copy fast: a **paid diagnostic** as the front door, **original research** that gets cited, and a **tracker** that makes an agency look like a software company. Their tracker is locked away. Appear is that product, sold openly.

€4,370	€7k–16k+	2M+	0
Paid diagnostic, credited back if they sign in 14 days	Monthly retainer range across three public tiers	AI citations analyzed in their flagship research study	Guarantees on rankings or citations

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01 · THE VERDICT

Five things that matter

Discovered Labs is not winning on content. It is winning on packaging, proof and a founder people already trust.

1 They sell a paid door, not a free audit

€4,370 diagnostic, delivered in 6 business days, 100% credited to month one. Buyers pay to qualify themselves, so every sales call is warm.

2 Pricing is public and productized

Three tiers measured in "content units" and staffed by a named pod. No custom quote theatre, no scope fights.

3 Research is the real marketing engine

Five studies now cited by HubSpot, Semrush and Wikipedia. That earns them the exact AI citations they sell. The best proof possible.

4 Tech is the trust story, not the product

Confidence intervals, three run confirmation, 1M+ answers a month. But clients only get view access, and it is not sold alone.

5 Founder fame closes the deal

Liam Dunne helped scale Instantly to $20M ARR. Instantly is now a client and testimonial. Instant credibility with SaaS founders.

PROFILE

Claim	"The First AEO/GEO Agency for B2B SaaS"
ICP	Series A+ SaaS, $10M to $30M+ ARR
Promise	Get found on Google, Bing, ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity
Team	About 20 named people, mostly editors and SEO, 2 data scientists
Base	Not stated, remote team, Portugal offsite 2026

CEO side

Liam Dunne

Cofounder. Ex Instantly growth, 20,000+ followers. The face, the content and the sales engine.

Tech side

Ben Moore

Cofounder and CTO. Ex Stanford AI research, Aurora self driving, fraud systems at Stripe and Coinbase.

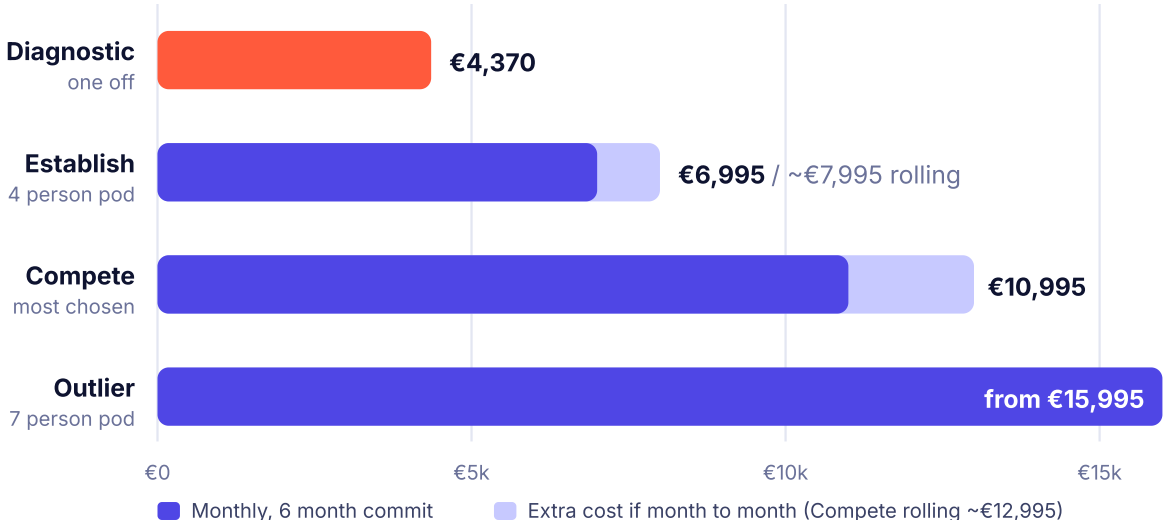
BIGGEST MOVE FOR US

Rank Collective launches a paid diagnostic plus public tiers within 30 days. Appear positions as "the tracker agencies keep behind the glass" and builds an agency partner program on it.

02 · THE OFFER

A clean price ladder with a paid first step

Every tier is public. The 6 month commit saves €1,000 to €2,000 a month, which quietly pushes buyers into longer contracts.



CONTENT UNITS



Blog **1 unit**

Page rework **5 units**

New page **7 units**

20 units on Establish, 30 on Compete. Kills scope creep and makes upsells feel natural.

NAMED FRAMEWORKS

- **4D:** Diagnose, Design, Deploy, Deepen
- **CITABLE:** content built to be cited
- **OPERABLE:** 8 point AI agent readiness
- **Citation Runbooks:** own pages, third party mentions, comparisons, review sites

TERMS

- 30 days notice to cancel
- Content live by day 10
- "AI citations" by day 30
- Weekly Slack, biweekly calls, monthly report
- **No guarantees** on rankings or citations

What each tier adds. Establish: tech audit, 2 landing pages and 10 Reddit mentions a month. Compete: new landing pages, 20 Reddit mentions, quarterly exec review. Outlier: programmatic pages, one research study per quarter, advanced tech SEO, a dedicated engineer.

03 · THE SALES MACHINE

Everything funnels into one call with the founder

No newsletter, no gated ebooks. Six layers whose only job is to make that 30 minute call feel like a privilege.



Every CTA on the site is the same: "Speak with team", a Calendly link with the cofounder.

Messaging patterns worth stealing

Sell pipeline, not rankings. Every case study leads with demos, SQLs, trials or activated users.

Name the engines. ChatGPT, Claude and Perplexity logos on the homepage. Buyers get it in one second.

Content framed as evidence. The blog is called "Evidence led field notes". Research, not marketing.

Own the comparison query. They wrote "7 Best GEO Agencies for B2B SaaS (2026)". LLMs pull from these lists.

04 · PROOF

Case studies that talk revenue, not rankings

Strong SaaS logos and pipeline numbers. All self reported on their own site, with no failures shown.

GRANOLA

+4,600%

monthly activated users from AI search

GLADIA

7x

sales accepted leads in 4 months, 93% of AI leads from LLMs

ANONYMOUS SAAS

6x

AI referred trials in 7 weeks, 3,500+ trials

GETVOCAL

3x

demo intent leads, 27x non branded impressions

SOVA ASSESSMENT

+167%

demo requests, now the #1 MQL channel

ADVISORYAI

+100%

year on year demo requests

INCIDENT.IO · AI VISIBILITY SCORE



38% before **64% after** +22% organic meetings booked

LOGO WALL

Instantly · incident.io · Gladia · Granola · Teachable · Composio · GetVocal · Sova · Passion.io · Paybis · Stuut · Cloud Employee

Testimonials include the CMO of incident.io and Instantly itself. Passion.io: "referrals from ChatGPT are up 29%" after one month.

RESEARCH ENGINE

- 2M AI citations across 10K pages: prompt and content alignment is the biggest lever
- 291,607 citations: how ChatGPT retrieves in 2026
- 144,284 citations on Reddit and LLMs
- Companies beat individual authors on Perplexity, 39.5% vs 27.1%
- What AI knows about 1,000 SaaS brands before web search

WHY THIS MATTERS

Their research is cited by HubSpot, Semrush and Wikipedia. That means LLMs cite them too. The marketing proves the service works, which is the most persuasive loop in the category.

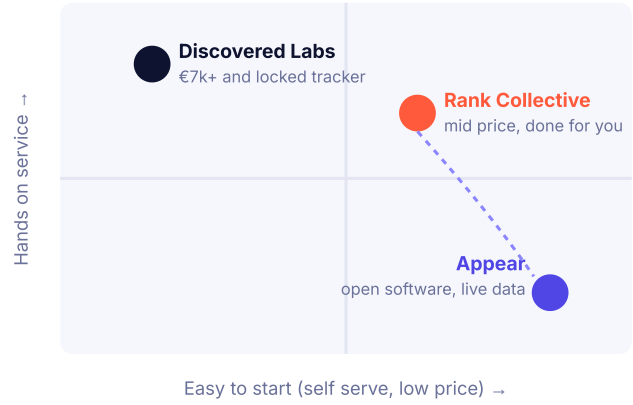
05 · WHERE THEY ARE EXPOSED

Strong on credibility, weak on access

Every gap below is an opening for Rank Collective or Appear.

AREA	THEIR GAP	HOW WE EXPLOIT IT	WHO
Entry point	€4,370 is steep for seed and Series A. The "free audit" is just a sales call	A real free AI visibility snapshot, then a cheaper paid deep dive	Both
Tracker	View only, retainer clients only, not sold alone	Appear is the open, self serve version anyone can try today	Appear
Price floor	Minimum about €7k a month, best rate needs 6 months	Own the €2.5k to €6k band they ignore	RC
ICP	Says SaaS only, then lists fintech, healthcare, services	Pick one clear niche they do not own	RC
Promises	"Performance based" but fixed fees and no guarantees	A real outcome guarantee or partial performance fee	RC
Consistency	Three different timelines, CITABLE has 5 checks or 7 signals	One clear promise, repeated everywhere	Both
Proof	All self reported, demo dashboard not labeled as sample	Live, verifiable client dashboards from Appear	Both
Audience	No newsletter, no email list	Weekly AI search newsletter, own the list	Both
Channels	Reddit capped at 10 to 20 mentions a month	Go heavier on Reddit, YouTube and review sites	RC

WHERE EVERYONE SITS



Directional, our read of positioning. Dotted line: Rank Collective runs on Appear.

BIGGEST THREAT TO APPEAR

If they ever sell their tracker as software, they become a direct competitor with agency distribution built in.

Answer: reach their prospects first, and sign agencies like them as Appear partners before they build their own.

06 · RANK COLLECTIVE

Copy the packaging, beat the price floor

Win on transparency and access, where they are weakest.

THE OPEN PRICE BAND



COPY

- **Paid sprint with credit back.** €1,500 to €2,500, 5 days, credited if they sign within 14 days
- **Three public tiers** named by ambition, middle one marked "most chosen"
- **Content units** to price work and stop scope creep
- **Show the pod.** Real roles, real faces
- **Citation Runbooks** as our delivery checklist
- **Own the listicle:** "Best AEO agencies for [niche] 2026"

ADAPT

- **Lighter research.** One study a quarter using Appear data, method published, pitched to press
- **Two or three free tools,** not seven. Start with an AI visibility checker on Appear
- **Pipeline first proof.** Revenue or leads up top, live Appear screenshot beside it
- **Founder brand.** 4 posts a week, contrarian and data backed

AVOID

- **Framework overload.** 4D, CITABLE, OPERABLE. Keep one, make it stick
- **Mixed messages** on timelines and ICP
- **"Performance based"** without performance pricing
- **No email list.** Start the newsletter on day one

SUGGESTED LADDER

Free
AI Visibility Snapshot
Powered by Appear, emailed in minutes

€1.5k to €2.5k
Visibility Sprint
5 days, fully credited

€2.5k to €4k / mo
Get Cited
Core content and runbooks

€4k to €6k / mo · most chosen
Own the Answer
Plus Reddit, PR and reviews

07 · APPEAR

Sell the belief they keep behind the glass

Discovered Labs proves SaaS buyers pay €7k to €16k a month for AI visibility, and the tracker is what makes them believe. Appear should sell that belief directly.

POSITIONING LINE TO TEST

"The AI visibility data top agencies keep behind the glass. Yours, live, from day one."

1 Steal their trust language

Run prompts many times, show confidence ranges, only count a move after three runs, sample prompts from Search Console, tickets and calls. It kills the "AI answers are random" objection.

2 Agency partner program

Every agency without a CTO is a buyer: white label dashboards, multi client workspaces, client view links. Rank Collective is partner zero.

3 Attribute pipeline, not mentions

They sell "AI referred trials" and "AI referred leads". Connect visibility to HubSpot, Salesforce and Attio. That is what CMOs renew on.

4 Turn their services into features

Content scoring, Reddit thread finder, comparison gaps, review site gaps, AI crawler detection in logs. Each one a feature page and a free tool.

5 Research as marketing

Appear sits on more prompt and citation data than any agency. One data study a month. Their 2M citation study is the bar.

6 Paid report that converts

A done for you AI visibility report with the fee credited to the subscription. Their diagnostic, as software.

THEIR FEATURES, OUR ROADMAP

DISCOVERED LABS CLAIM	APPEAR ANGLE
95% confidence ranges, 3 run confirmation	Show it in the product, write a public methodology page
Prompts sampled from GSC, tickets, calls	Prompt import from Search Console and CRM call notes
Agentic browsing checker, CDN agent logs	AI crawler and agent traffic module
ModelRank: what AI knows before web search	Training data brand audit as a free tool

Watch item: same ICP as Appear (Series A+ B2B SaaS). Track their research and case studies monthly for sharper sales answers.

08 · NEXT 30 DAYS

Offer, then proof, then audience

Twelve moves. Each one is small enough to ship in a week.

1 2 3 4

WEEK 1
Offer

- [ ] RC Define the paid sprint: price, 5 day delivery, credit rule
- [ ] RC Three public tiers in content units, floor under €6k
- [ ] Appear Test "behind the glass" in 2 outbound sequences

WEEK 2
Proof

- [ ] Both Rewrite top 3 case studies around pipeline plus live data
- [ ] Appear Publish the methodology page
- [ ] Both Publish our "Best AEO agencies and tools 2026" page

WEEK 3
Authority

- [ ] Appear Start the first data study
- [ ] Both Launch the free AI visibility checker
- [ ] Both Founder posting 4x a week, 1 data post weekly

WEEK 4
Distribution

- [ ] Both Launch the weekly AI search newsletter
- [ ] Appear Partner program outline, sign RC as partner zero
- [ ] Appear Publish the study, pitch 20 newsletters and journalists

TWO DECISIONS THAT UNLOCK THIS

- **Which niche** does Rank Collective want to own? Ecommerce, DTC, local or European mid market are all open.
- **Does Appear** already run each prompt multiple times with confidence ranges? If yes, shout it. If no, prioritize it.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE BY DAY 30

- First 3 paid sprints sold
- Public pricing page live
- Free checker capturing leads daily
- One agency partner signed on Appear

Sources (read 29 October 2026): discoveredlabs.com homepage, /pricing, /about, /case-studies, /methodology, /services/answer-engine-optimization-agency, /technology/ai-visibility-tracker, /research, /blog, /careers. Prices in EUR as listed. Rolling monthly prices are derived from their stated savings. Client results are self reported and not independently verified.